THE URBAN GLOW

My 2026 Marker Recipe & Palette Guide

🛒 THE HARDWARE

Your Real 2026 Street-Art Materials

🎨 THE ACRYLIC

Posca Markers

The go-to for bold, opaque color. Shake, prime, and press.

🖊️ THE DETAIL

Grabie Dual Tip Markers

Fine tip for line-work. Brush tip for fills and blending.

🖌️ THE PAINT

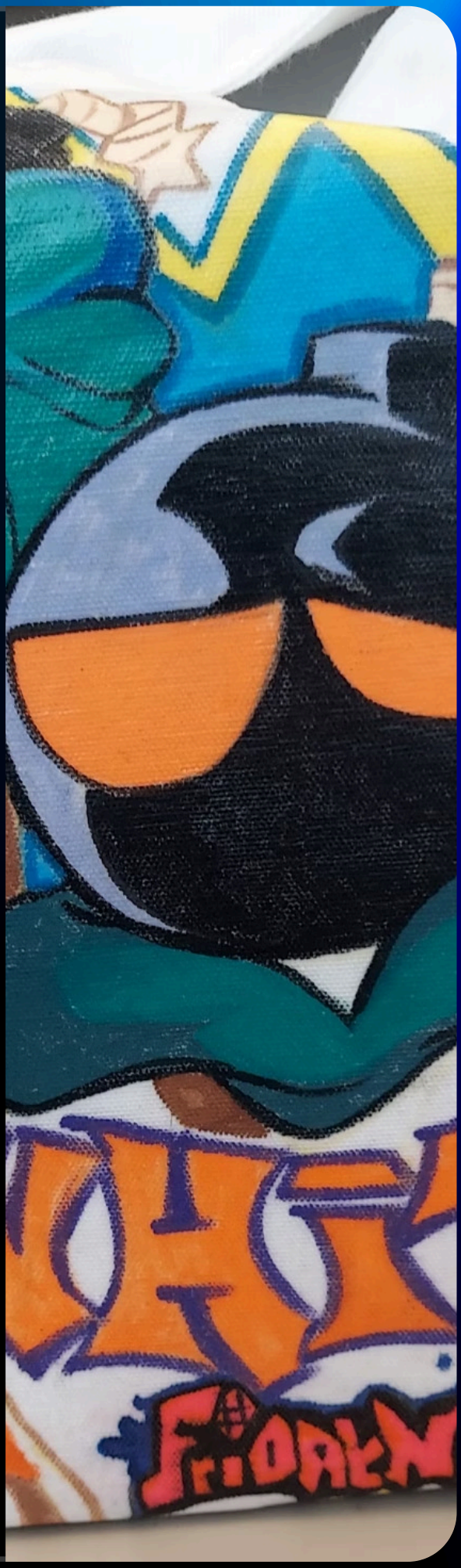
Artecho Acrylic Paint Markers

Extra coverage for large fills and deep color layering.

📄 THE CANVAS

Winsor & Newton 200gsm Mixed Media Paper

Heavy enough to handle wet layers without warping.



🎨 THE SOFTWARE

The Deep Palette — How the Layers Work

It's not about one perfect color. It's about what each layer is doing to the one underneath it.

🧢 THE BASE LAYER

Your first pass sets the tone. It doesn't need to be perfect — it needs to be even. This is the foundation everything else sits on.

❤️ THE SHADOW LAYER

Darker tones go in second. Push them into the edges and creases. This is where depth comes from — not from one dark color, but from contrast between layers.

⚡ THE HIGHLIGHT & GLOW

White goes on last. Always. One clean stroke on the highest point — the hat brim, the lightning center, the jacket shoulder. That contrast is what creates the glow. You're not adding light. You're revealing it.

THE CANVAS — THE REAL PROCESS

From Blank Page to Urban Glow

Every piece starts the same way. Base first. Then build. Here's the actual order that makes it work.

🎨 START WITH THE BASE

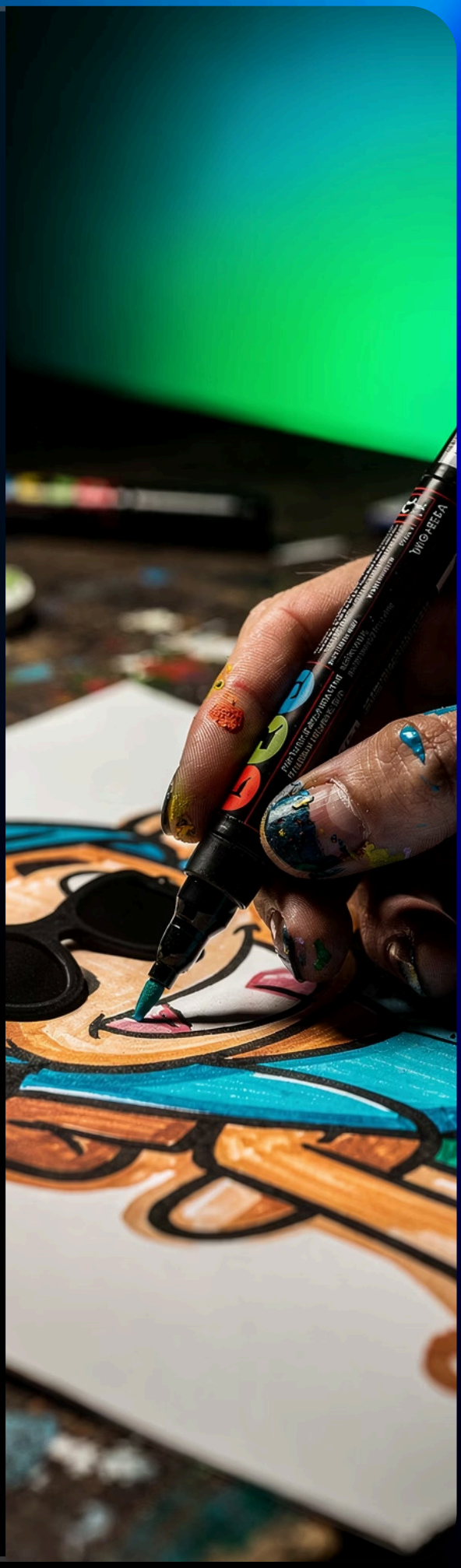
Lay down your lightest color first across the full area. Don't rush it. One smooth pass. This is your foundation — everything layers on top of this.

⏱️ BUILD CONTRAST CAREFULLY

Let each layer dry before adding the next. Wet ink on wet ink turns muddy. Dry layers stack clean. The contrast between your base and shadow is where the character starts to feel three-dimensional.

⚡ SAVE THE HIGHLIGHTS FOR LAST

White accents go on at the very end. A thin line on the lightning bolt. A touch on the hat brim. These small marks do the most work — they tell the eye where the light is hitting and make the whole piece glow.



⚡ THE PRO-INTAKE

Read This Before You Touch the Paper

These are not tips. These are the things that separate a clean piece from a wasted one.

⏱️ DRY TIME MATTERS

Wait between layers. If the paper is still wet when you add the next color, they blend into mud. 60 seconds is the minimum. When in doubt, wait longer.

💪 PRESSURE CONTROL

Posca and acrylic markers are pump-based. Too much pressure floods the tip. Prime them on scrap paper first. On your actual piece, use light, even strokes — let the ink do the work.

🖊️ OUTLINES COME LAST

Whether you use cheap markers or expensive ones, technique still matters more than the tool. Do your black outlines after the color is dry. It keeps edges crisp and stops the ink from dragging color across your lines.

Cheap or expensive — technique matters more than the tool. Master the process first.

📄 DOWNLOAD THE URBAN GLOW GUIDE (PDF)

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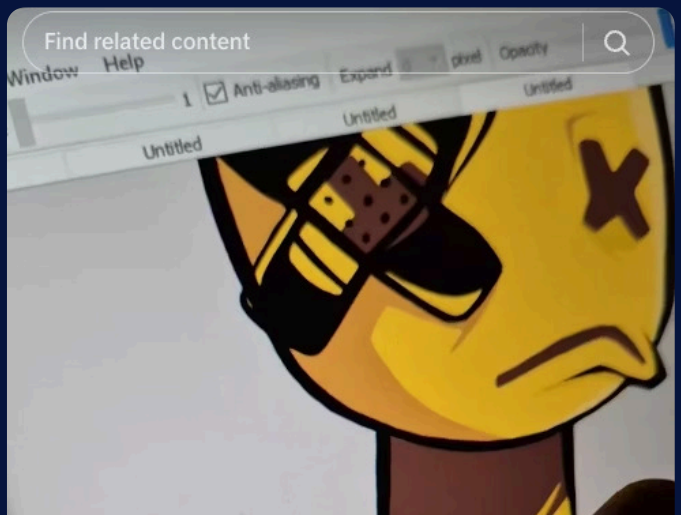
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